

Shell Velocity Rewards MVP

Designing a petrol-retail rewards experience around the real rhythm of a fuel stop.

JOHANNESBURG PILOT

CARD-AGNOSTIC

CASHLESS

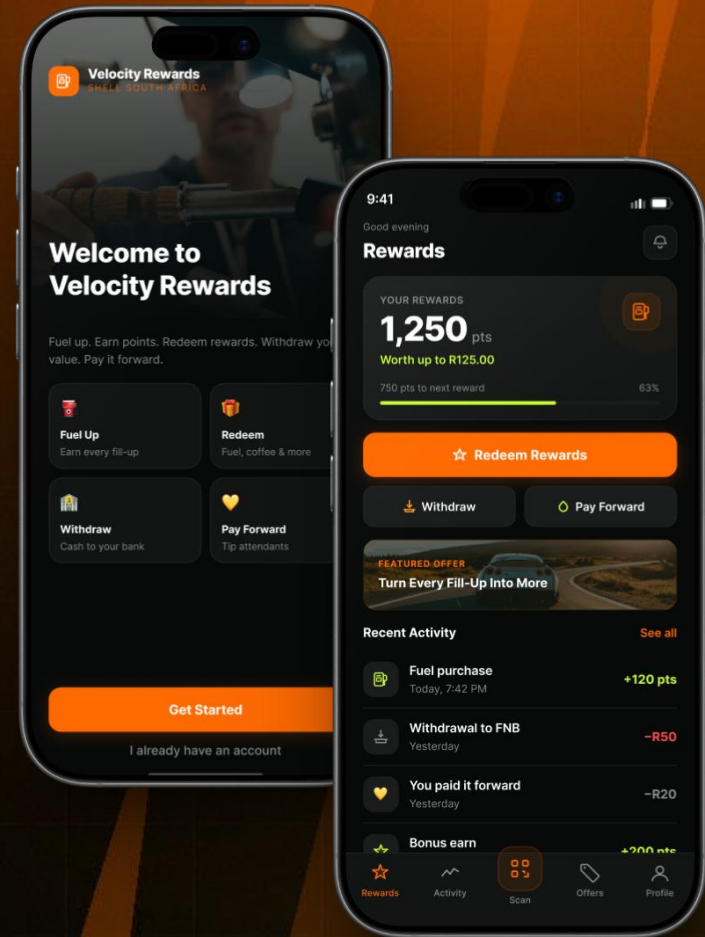
Concept project · individual contributor

DESIGNED FOR THE NEXT STOP



VISIBLE VALUE

Flexible redemption. Payment freedom. Intentional tipping.



From forecourt friction to repeat engagement.

01 Project framing

02 Research + competitor signal

03 Behavioural archetypes (hypotheses)

04 Hypotheses + MVP definition

05 Success model

06 Journey + interaction design

07 Final UI + next iteration

“

Picture Lindiwe, pulling into a Shell garage on her way to work. She's filled up here a dozen times this year. She has no idea how many rewards she's sitting on, and no real reason to check.

Her card's buried in a drawer at home somewhere. As far as she's concerned, whatever she's earned might as well not exist.



The problem and the opportunity

South African motorists who refuel at Shell service stations in Johannesburg just like Lindiwe have a card-based programme which ties their rewards to a card they hardly carry and a points balance they never see, while also lacking an easy digital way to tip fuel attendants.

That's not a minor UX gap. A programme customers can't see or act on daily is a programme that costs money to run without earning the repeat visits it's meant to buy. Low visibility isn't just an inconvenience; it's the mechanism that erodes the entire business case for the programme.

We will conduct an exploratory investigation to identify core friction points and define a focused, frictionless MVP digital rewards ecosystem.

Research method

I audited loyalty models across five fuel-retail and adjacent high-frequency categories: supermarket loyalty, banking rewards, and fuel rewards to see which mechanics correlated with sustained use versus quiet abandonment.

Sasol Rewards

BP Rewards

Engen 1App

Discovery Vitality Money

eBucks

WHY A COMPETITOR ANALYSIS?

Constraints

This was self-directed work, without access to real Shell users or stakeholders to validate assumptions through interviews. Rather than skip research, I substituted a structured competitive and market audit for direct interviews, a reasonable trade-off in early concept work, but one that means the findings are directional, not validated. Programme economics (the cost of cash withdrawals and points-funded tips) were also out of scope and would need modelling before any pilot.

Full competitive audit (1 of 2)

Sasol Rewards

- Simple, familiar earn rate customers already trust simplified earn-rate (points per litre)
- Shared family/friends account builds habitual use
- Wide network of stations across the country

Works with any
card/payment method



Cashless, instant
redemption



Built-in
tipping



BP Rewards

- Stacks with Smart Shopper for a near-best combined earn rate
- Backed by an established retail partner network
- Cashback feels tangible and easy to understand



Engen 1App

- In-house wallet app layered onto Clicks ClubCard and FNB eBucks
- Value depends on holding specific partner cards
- Several users report unclear point tracking and hard-to-read text



Full competitive audit (2 of 2)

eBucks

- Deep bank integration drives loyalty across many categories
- High reward ceiling for top-tier banking customers
- Rewards extend across groceries, travel, and more

Works with any
card/payment method



Cashless, instant
redemption



Built-in
tipping



Discovery Vitality

- Highest possible cashback, up to 50% on fuel spend
- Strong behavioural engagement through driving-score gamification
- Reinforces an existing wellness/insurance relationship



Tappy

- Already solves cashless tipping for petrol attendants directly
- No app, card, or bank account needed for the attendant
- Fast, lightweight rollout with minimal setup cost



Poor / not offered



Partial



Strong / fully offered

What the market audit suggests

- **Visibility is the biggest driver of disengagement**

The clearest pattern: low visibility into points and rewards was the single biggest driver of disengagement.

- **Invisible value gets abandoned**

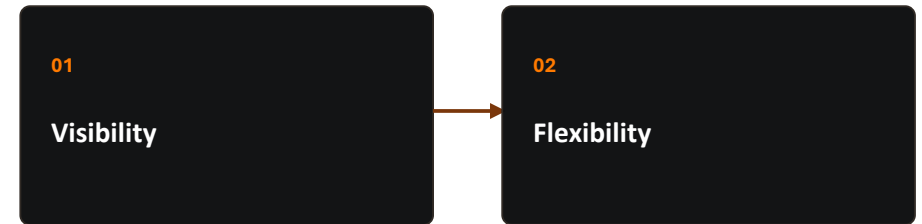
Customers who couldn't easily see what they'd earned, or how to use it, simply stopped engaging.

- **Integrated tipping is a defensible asset**

Tappy already solves cashless tipping on its own, but no rewards programme in the audit lets customers tip from their rewards inside the same journey. That integration, not tipping itself, is Velocity's most distinctive lever.

- **Flexibility that exists on paper isn't flexibility**

Several programmes offered genuinely flexible redemption: partner catalogues, multiple reward types, tiered perks, but buried those options three or four menus deep, or gated them behind thresholds the customer couldn't see until reached.



Visibility and flexibility must work together, not just exist separately. That combined finding set the direction for the design.



Lindiwe Sibanda

The Balance- and Value-Conscious Parent

Age: 45

Occupation: Associate Consultant

Children: 2

Payment method: Debit card / occasionally cash

1 of 3

HYPOTHESIS ARCHETYPE

Moment of Truth

"If it saves us money on the school run and the weekend wash, we're in."

Behaviours

- Refuels 2–3 times a week, often with her children in the car
- Uses the convenience store regularly to buy her children snacks
- Switches between card and cash depending on what she has in her wallet

Goal

- Redeem points across services (fuel, wash, kiosk)
- Track shared/family rewards balance easily
- Stretch family budget further

Frustrations

- Redemption restrictions that don't match real spending habits
- Confusing points-to-value conversions
- Rewards tied to a single card, restricting shared use

Motivations

- Being able to use rewards flexibly across all services
- Transparency and fairness
- Tangible, easily understood value systems that aren't confusing

Archetype drawn from the competitor audit and market patterns, not from user interviews. Treat it and its quote as a hypothesis to validate.



Lesego Molefe

The Time-Pressed, Impatient Commuter

Age: 32

Occupation: Data Engineer

Children: None

Payment method: Apple Pay or card

2 of 3

HYPOTHESIS ARCHETYPE

Moment of Truth

"I don't have time to be busy with an app while at the pump that requires my time and effort. Make it quick or I'm out."

Behaviours

- Refuels 1–2 times a week at the same station on her commute
- Pays by card or Apple Pay, rarely carries cash
- Checks her phone briefly at the pump machine

Goal

- Fill up quickly on the way to work
- Avoid queues and friction at the till
- Get some value back without extra effort

Frustrations

- Loyalty apps that require log-ins
- Rewards that expire before she can use them
- Juggling which card earns which reward
- Being asked to download another app for a small benefit

Motivations

- Convenience and speed
- Predictability
- Not feeling penalised for using whatever card is in her wallet that day

Archetype drawn from the competitor audit and market patterns, not from user interviews. Treat it and its quote as a hypothesis to validate.



Jabulani Dube

The Regular, Generous Loyalist

Age: 35

Occupation: Bolt Driver

Children: 1

Payment method: Cash and card

3 of 3

HYPOTHESIS ARCHETYPE

Moment of Truth

"The petrol attendants know my name. If there was an easier way to thank them digitally, I would do it all the time."

Behaviours

- Refuels almost every day, in small frequent top-ups
- Already tips informally in cash when he has it

Goal

- Fuel efficiently between rides to maximise earning time
- Build a closer relationship with the fuel attendants, as some have become friends
- Redeem rewards on everyday essentials like refreshments and snacks from the kiosk

Frustrations

- No way to tip the attendants digitally
- Cash tipping feels inconsistent, and feels like he is disappointing his friends when he can't tip them

Motivations

- Social connection and recognition at his local station
- A sense of generosity and community
- Flexibility, since his payment method is different by day

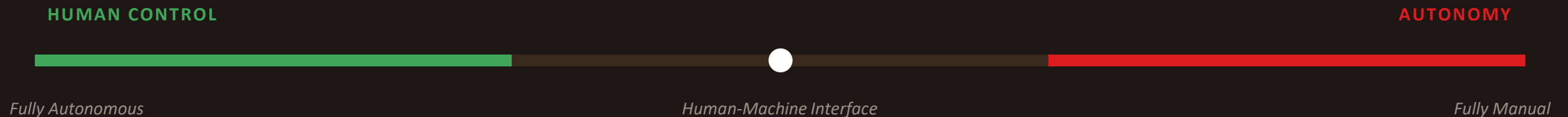
Archetype drawn from the competitor audit and market patterns, not from user interviews. Treat it and its quote as a hypothesis to validate.

What the three archetypes point to



The common thread beneath all three archetypes is control:

- Control over which payment method is used
- Control over where value can be redeemed
- Control over how generosity is expressed



The MVP's job is to remove the constraints that currently take that control away.

***Tension to test:** Lesego will not spend effort on an app at the pump, yet the MVP is app-based. The bet is that one glance at a visible balance replaces card juggling. Task tests must time this at the pump.*



Four hypotheses I would validate first.

H1 VISIBILITY

Reward visibility increases return engagement.

H2 CARD-AGNOSTIC

Card-agnostic earning matters.

H3 CASH-OUT

Customers value withdrawing rewards as cash.

H4 TIPPING

Digital tipping belongs inside the loyalty journey.

DECISION RULE

If a hypothesis fails, that MVP behaviour is cut or reshaped, not defended.

The MVP is four behaviours, not a long feature list.

01 SEE IT

One unified, visible balance

02 USE IT NOW

Redeem during the fuel stop

03 PAY MY WAY

Keep payment card-agnostic

04 THANK CLEARLY

Separate digital tipping from redemption

Core MVP success matrix

How I'd measure success

01

SIGN-UP RATE

REJECTED

Curiosity can be bought; it does not prove behaviour changed.

02

REDEMPTION RATE

SECONDARY

Proves the flow works, but not whether the customer returns.

03

REPEAT ENGAGEMENT

PRIMARY

Directly tests whether visibility and control create habit. Target set against a pre-pilot baseline of current programme members.

30/60

day return rate vs. baseline

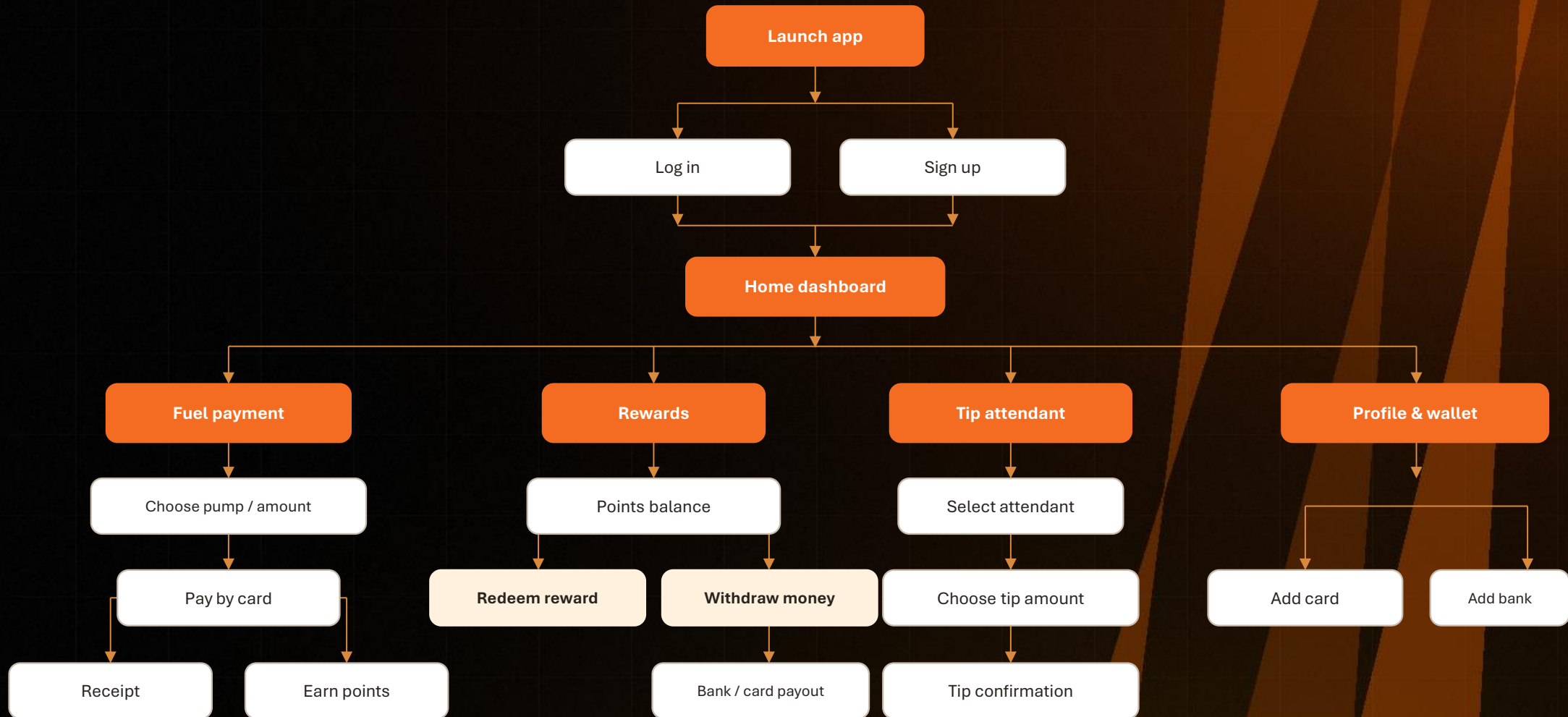
PRIMARY

repeat engagement

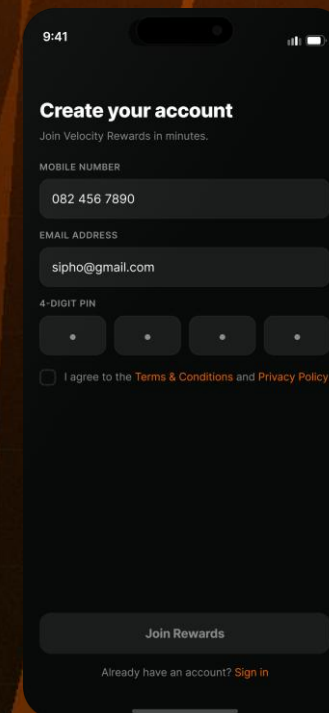
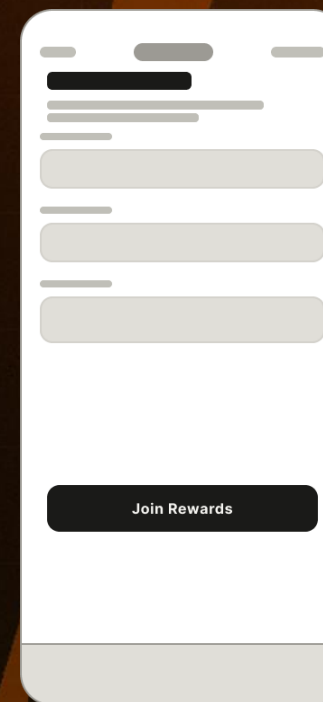
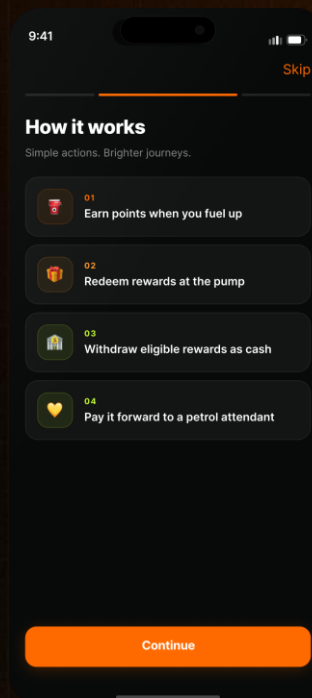
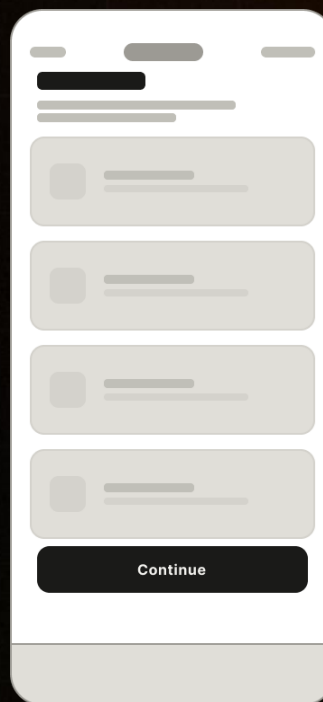
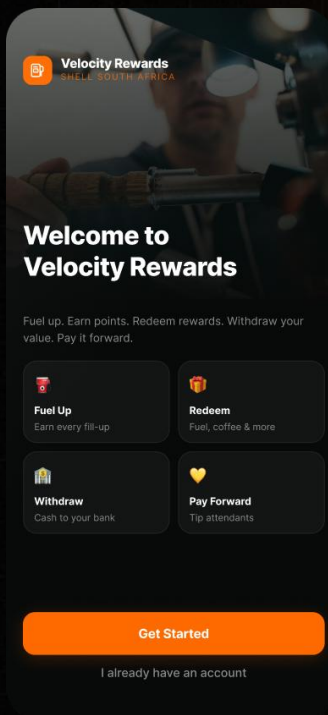
WHY

the experience should earn another stop

The digital flow mirrors the physical station journey.



32 DESIGN SCREENS



Key decisions & visual design system

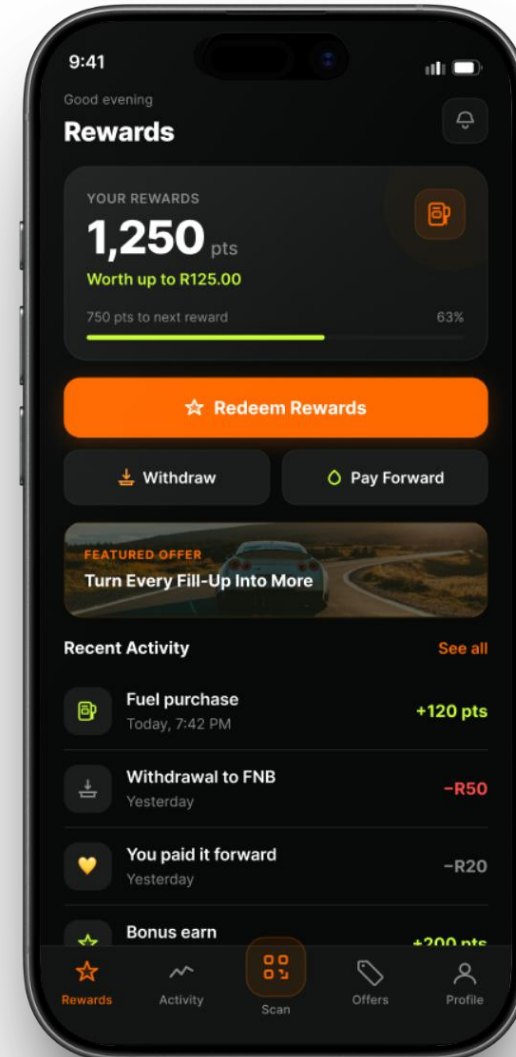
01 SEE IT

One unified balance, not separate wallets

Decision: Fuel and in-store purchases feed one visible points balance.

Rejected: Separate fuel-points and shop-points wallets that mirror Shell's business structure. Many balances are harder to track than one.

Effect: One number reinforces the “one programme” mental model and makes rewards an active part of the experience.



Key decisions & visual design system

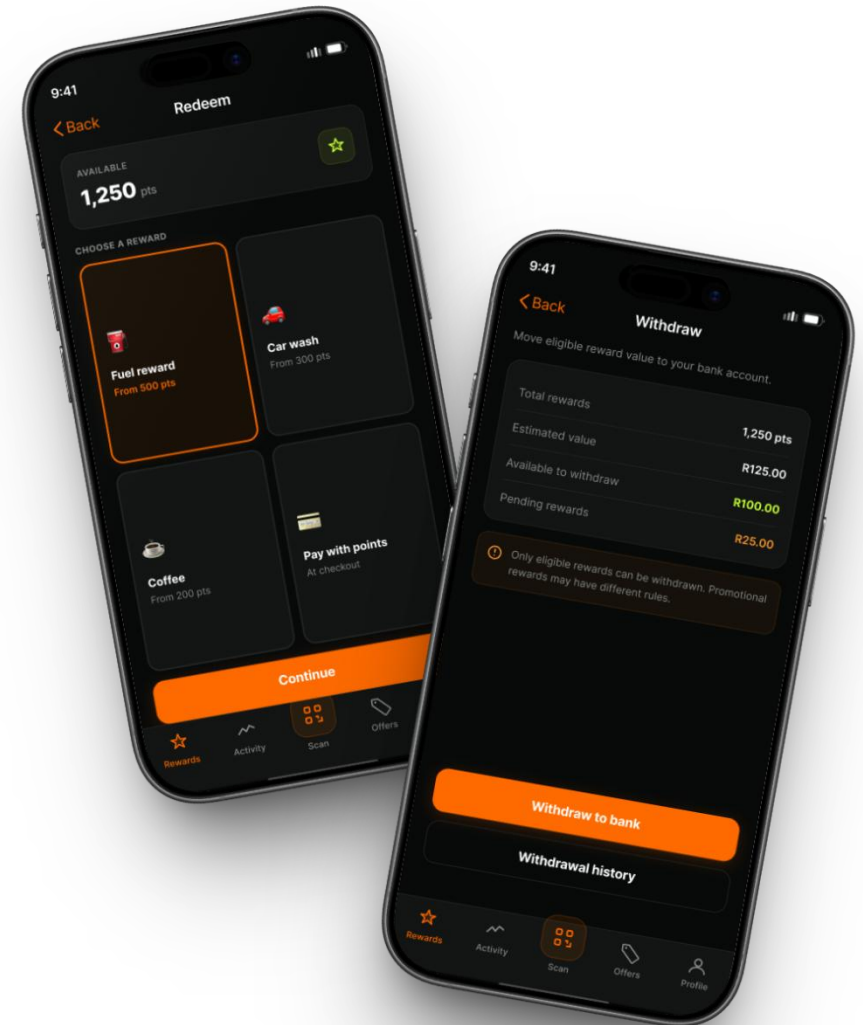
02 USE IT NOW

Real-time visibility and control over point usage

Decision: Users can redeem or withdraw value close to the moment it is earned.

Rejected: High redemption thresholds, delayed rewards and restricted catalogues. They suit long-term accumulation but make the benefit feel distant.

Effect: Shortens the distance between behaviour and benefit. Value should not only be earned; it should be usable.



Key decisions & visual design system

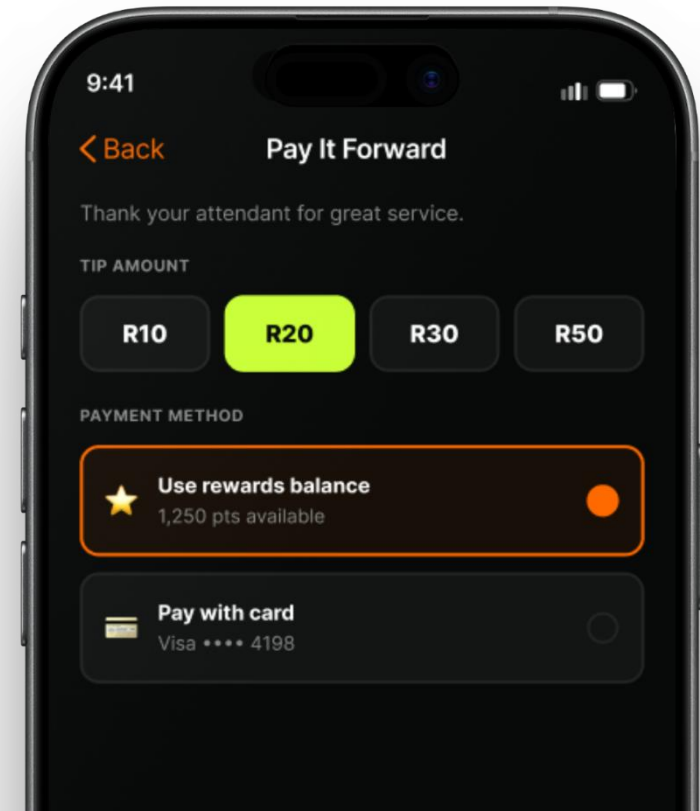
03 PAY MY WAY

Preserve customer freedom

Decision: Earning stays payment-agnostic; customers choose how they pay.

Rejected: A bank-linked or single-card structure that requires a specific financial product to qualify.

Effect: Broadens participation and keeps Shell, not a banking partner, at the centre of the loyalty relationship.



Key decisions & visual design system

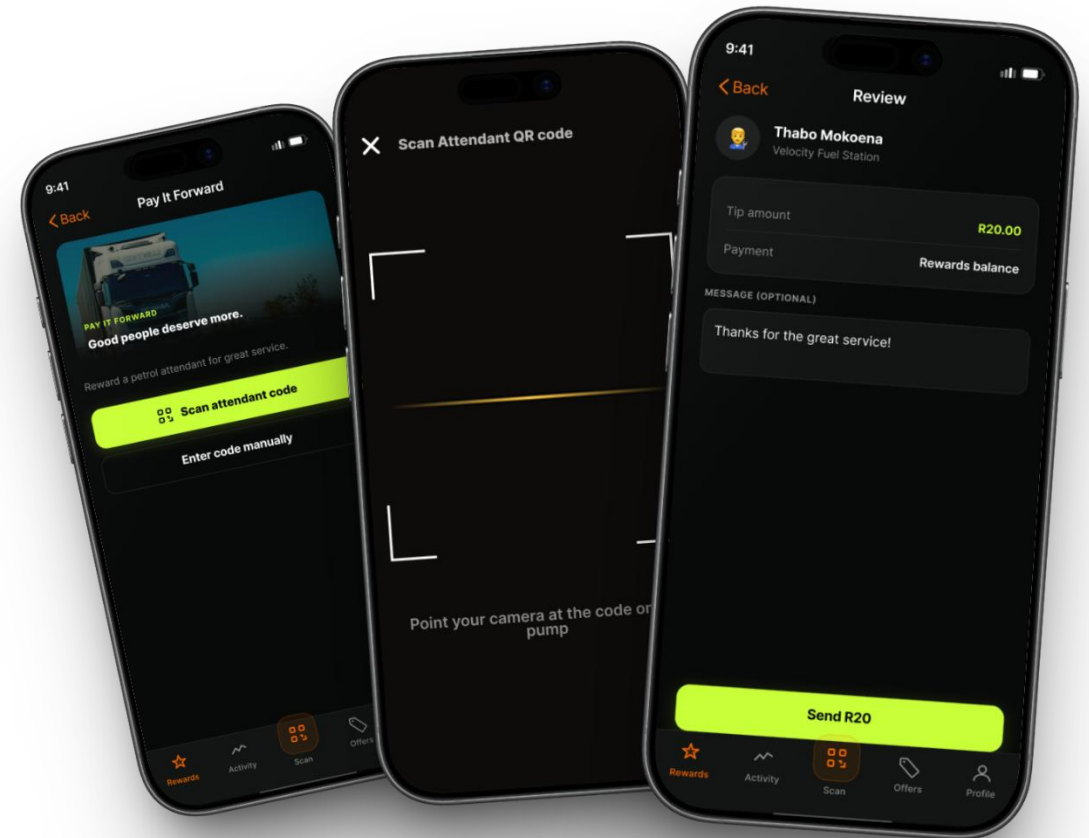
04 THANK CLEARLY

Bring the human service layer into the ecosystem

Decision: Tipping is separate from the fuel transaction, with recipient and amount made explicit.

Rejected: A purely transactional journey, and gratuity bundled invisibly into the fuel payment.

Effect: Preserves the human layer of the forecourt while supporting a cashless future.



Design system at a glance

COLOUR

Orange

#FF6A00

Action, fuel

Lime

#C9FF38

Rewards, success

Amber

#FF9A2F

Pending, warnings

Error

#FF4D4D

Failures, debits

Background

#080A09

Text

#FFFFFF

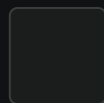
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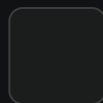
Inter

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BORDER RADIUS



r-1



r-2



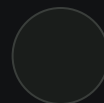
r-3



r-4



r-5



r-full

SPACING · BASE 4PX



NEXT ITERATION

The next test belongs at the station.

The concept should now meet real motorists, attendants and operational constraints.

01 INTERVIEWS

Test H1–H4: visibility, card-agnostic earning, cash-out, in-journey tipping.

02 TASK TESTS

Test comprehension of balance, redeem and tip flows.

03 LIVE PILOT

Track 30/60-day return vs. baseline, service-time impact and programme cost.

04 ITERATE

Keep only the mechanics that earn another visit.

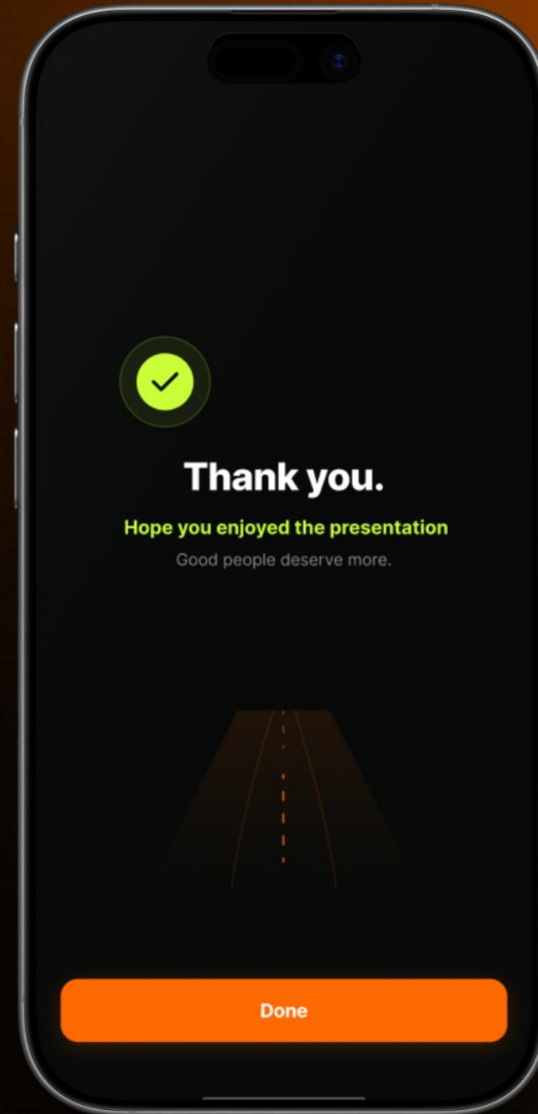
PORTFOLIO TAKEAWAY

I used imperfect evidence to make a precise design bet then defined how I would prove or disprove it.

THANK YOU

A rewards experience designed around the real rhythm of the forecourt.

SEE VALUE · USE IT NOW · COME BACK



DESIGNED FOR

THE NEXT STOP